Development Progress Report

A visual representation of why one geography develops faster.

China — secured by geography



A great power now confident that it is secured by its geographical features.

Africa — prisoners of geography



Many Africans are now partially prisoners of the political geography the Europeans made, and of the natural barriers to progression with which nature endowed them.

Project milestones

01 Heartland & the Hu Line

SECURED

The most important factor: a great power now confident that it is secured by its geographical features.

02 Borders & buffer zones

SECURED

Security bought by the buffers frees money for development, but at the cost of unrest in the border regions.

03 Navy & the South China Sea

SECURED

The sea extends China's secure core outwards into trade, resources and jobs — a step Africa has never been able to take.

01 Natural barriers — a negative factor

BLOCKED

Geography as a whole is underestimated; it explains much of Africa's technological and political deficiency.

02 Borders drawn by colonialism & war

BLOCKED

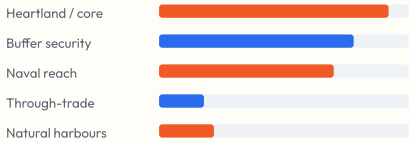
Imposed borders turned natural division into permanent conflict, blocking the stable core that China enjoys.

03 Population growth

RISING

Inevitable disparity: many will live in slums, which overall hinders development.

Key performance



Heartland, buffers and navy vs rivers, harbours and borders.

1 in 4 people



1 in 4

an extra billion people

Africa's population challenge — p. 217

Similarities

Geography first

Both are continental-scale regions whose fate was set by geography before politics. Both live with buffers…

Differences

One core vs many splits

China has one fertile, river-linked heartland walled in by mountains and desert, so it became a single centralise…

Which would be bigger?

Africa in area, China in use

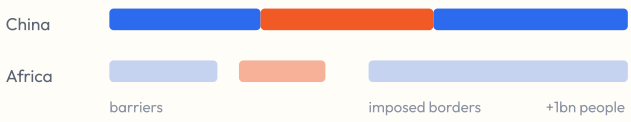
Africa is roughly three times China's land area and has a similar population today, with Africa's set to grow far…

Why does one develop faster?

Unity was cheap

China's geography concentrates people, food and power. Africa's disperses and obstructs, and imposed…

Projected vs actual timelines



Quotations from Tim Marshall, Prisoners of Geography. China pp. 52–54; Africa pp. 170, 217.